

Website-Based Digital Marketing and Digital Branding as a Strategy to Increase Ecoprint Product Sales at Tembindigo MSME

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Abstract

Tembindigo MSME, a natural textile-based enterprise, faces challenges in expanding its market reach due to limited digital marketing strategies and the absence of an integrated branding platform. The primary issue lies in the lack of a professional website and a consistent digital content management system, which hinders market penetration both nationally and internationally. This community engagement project aims to design and develop a professional website as the center of digital marketing, optimize digital marketing strategies, and enhance visual appeal through product storytelling. The method employed is Participatory Action Research (PAR), which involves the business owner and three employees across three stages: website development, social media optimization, and visual content enhancement. The success indicators include the availability of core features, integration of social media, and validation of visual and storytelling content. The main findings reveal that the website significantly increased business exposure, as evidenced by a spike in visitor traffic and a rise in sales of accessory products and workshop services. Specifically, visual consistency, narrative clarity, and ease of ordering were key factors in attracting new customers. The results of this activity provide practical insights for other ecoprint-based MSMEs seeking to adopt a structured, integrated, and locally rooted website-based digital branding strategy in response to digital transformation.

Keywords: MSMEs, digital branding, website, storytelling, ecoprint

INTRODUCTION

Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) are the backbone of Indonesia's economy since they are fundamental in advancing the informal sector and employing a significant portion of the workforce. As reported by the Ministry of Cooper MSMEs (2023), Indonesia distinguishes that Indonesia has more than 64 million MSMEs, which contribute around 61.07% of the Gross Domestic Product (GDP), alongside employing nearly 97% of the workforce. Therefore, they serve as one of the most crucial pillars for sustaining the economy and reducing poverty. Supporting this claim, Ariningrum et al. (2024); Lestari & Sudarmiatin (2024); Suprayogi et al. (2024) have mentioned in their works the vital role MSMEs play in the Indonesian economy and employment. Furthermore, in alignment with the growing creative industry and market demand for sustainable alternatives, eco-friendly natural-textile MSMEs, such as ecoprint, have shown significant potential to satisfy consumer demands for green products. One such MSME is Tembindigo, located in Bantencio, Yogyakarta, which specializes in ecoprint, focusing on the innovation of natural textiles, and nurturing products through educational training. The company also operates a gallery as a promotional tool. However, Tembindigo relies on conventional marketing strategies, utilizing partnerships with tour guides and local hotels, as well as direct sales through their galleries. Despite these approaches achieving penetration into the domestic and international markets, there are still unutilized opportunities provided by digital marketing platforms (RAMLI et al., 2023; Sofianti et al., 2024). Outdated marketing strategies, excluding the use of modern technologies, have become a major hindrance to growing both sales volume and competitiveness (Badri & Amrina, 2023; Nurlina et al., 2023). Hence, the adoption of technology-centered marketing techniques and evolving branding strategies is crucial for sustaining adaptability and flexibility in a globalized atmosphere for MSMEs such as Tembindigo.

Lack of a professionally integrated digital marketing system to support sustainable business growth is one of the primary challenges that Tembindigo grapples with. The firm's social media accounts on Instagram, TikTok, Shopee, Facebook, and YouTube are part of the ecosystem; however, their usage lacks consistency and order, as an overarching digital strategy is absent (CHERNIAVSKA & KAZNODII, 2024; Wahyudin et al., 2023). Admittedly, while some content pieces uploaded include elements of narrative storytelling (a crucial component for building emotional bonds with consumers), there is an absence of brand identity and engaging storytelling around products (Chen & Mathews, 2013). Additionally, the absence of a centralized digital hub that integrates various marketing channels hinders customer engagement, particularly for international customers. The absence of a professionally designed and bilingual website has been cited as one of the biggest barriers to effective cross-cultural communication, thus crippling efforts to reach global markets (Triwiyanto et al., 2023). Therefore, developing a cohesive and integrated website-centered digital branding strategy becomes an undeniable key requirement. An organizational website serves multiple functions, such as an information dissemination tool, a platform for promotion, a product catalog, a customer engagement platform, and a transactional interface where business interactions reinforce the brand image and business reputation (Yousif, 2024). Recent research also shows that MSMEs implementing all-encompassing digital frameworks have markedly enhanced their market competitiveness and trust among consumers.

Earlier research have highlighted the importance of digital transformation for Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) as a competitive response in the digital economy context. As discussed by Salsabila et al. (2024) and Rahman & Mardiana (2024), having a professional website not only boosts consumer trust but also significantly improves market access. Moreover, research by Risdwiyanto et al. (2023) and Lestari (2022) confirms that loyal customers, particularly those from the MSME sector dealing in crafts, respond positively to strong digital branding strategies. However, many social responsibility initiatives appear to focus primarily on teaching social media management skills, overlooking the need for an integrated digital marketing framework and ecosystem (Istanti et al., 2024; Rochimah et al., 2023; Triyanto et al., 2021). Teaching skills in visual content and digital branding execution has shown a significant impact, such as a 40% improvement in brand awareness among supported MSMEs over a three-month period (Fridayani et al., 2024). However, these enhancements in visual branding have not yet been addressed through a comprehensive digital marketing strategy, such as developing a professional website. Thus, the integration of digital branding, website creation, and storytelling into the marketing strategy of local MSMEs, as well as brand narrative construction, marks a shift towards more sustainable and holistic paradigms that require further research (Andhini & Andanawarih, 2023). These aspects are vital not only for improving digital presence but also for fostering emotional engagement alongside customer loyalty amidst competition in the marketplace.

Based on the aforementioned problems, this community engagement initiative aims to: (1) design and develop a professional website as a central hub for the integration of Tembindigo MSME's digital marketing activities; (2) optimize digital marketing strategies through the management of social media content integrated with the website; and (3) enhance the appeal of digital marketing through product storytelling, professional photography, and a visual branding approach grounded in local values to reach both national and international markets.

METHODS

This community engagement initiative employed a Participatory Action Research (PAR) framework in conjunction with Science and Technology Dissemination (Ipteks) to facilitate the digital transformation of the targeted MSMEs (Febrianty et al., 2024; Thomas et al., 2023). The choice of PAR was because this approach offers a participatory space for MSME actors at every stage—problem identification, solution formulation, implementation, and collaborative evaluation. This approach has effectively fostered strong ownership over the innovations developed, particularly about the shift toward enhanced digital capacity grounded in local cultural contexts (Yanto et al., 2022). Additionally, PAR facilitates direct knowledge transfer processes tailored to the specific needs and characteristics of each MSME partner. Evidence from previous studies demonstrates that MSME partners active throughout the engagement process not only acquire

digital skills but also develop lasting innovative capacities as a result of a supportive cooperative climate. The combination of Ipteks' dissemination approaches with the PAR framework enables the development of contextual yet real solutions to pressing issues facing MSMEs in the digital age.

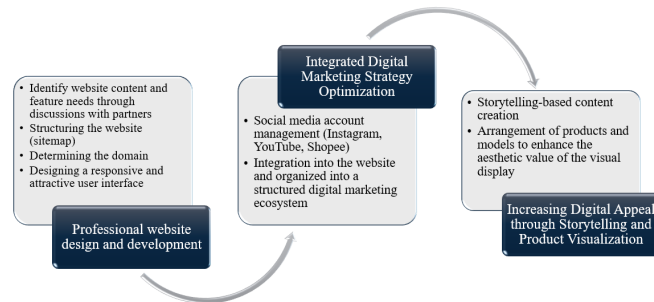


Figure 1. Stages of Community Service Implementation

This activity included one business owner and three staff members of Tembindigo MSME. They conducted information collection, needs assessment, content creation, and validation of the outcomes as illustrated in Figure 1. The integrated digital marketing media reflecting the values and identity of Ecoprint products were developed from May to July 2025. The data encompassed visual documentation of the products, a narrative history, and the philosophy behind the motifs, as well as the production process and customer contact information. All data were validated with Tembindigo MSME. Validation criteria included design and development of the website (Table 1), optimization of the digital marketing efforts (Table 2), and enhancement of digital appeal (Table 3).

Table 1. Validation of Professional Website Design and Development

Targeted output	Achievement indicators	Validation method
Tembindigo MSME professional website as a digital marketing integration center	Website is active and publicly accessible Complete and structured product catalog display Production process information page available Business profile page and customer testimonials appear Order form feature is active WhatsApp admin contact feature available Website is available in two languages (Indonesian & English) Links to social media are available	Website functional access test and Feature and page checklist

Table 2. Validation of Integrated Digital Marketing Strategy Optimization

Targeted output	Achievement indicators	Validation methods
MSME social media is well managed and integrated into the website	Instagram, YouTube, and Shopee accounts are active and connected to the website Latest visual content is available on each platform Increased number of followers and interactions (likes, comments, shares) Regular upload schedule available (minimum 2x/week) Training materials: copywriting techniques, upload time, utilization of story/reels features Digital marketing training is carried out with the participation of partners	Social media logs Training documentation Content analysis and platform insights

Table 3. Increasing Digital Appeal through Storytelling and Product Visualization

Targeted output	Achievement indicators	Validation methods
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Interesting storytelling and product visualization content that illustrates the product's value	Product storytelling narrative (philosophy, motifs, processes) available on website and social media Professional photography sessions documented Product images are of high quality and aesthetic composition Visual content is used consistently across platforms Brand identity is reflected through color tones, logos, and visual styles	Validate narrative with partners Review visual appearance of website and social media Feedback from social media audience and customers
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RESULT AND DISCUSSION

The creation of the website tembindigo.co.id followed both legal and technical steps aligned with the domain name for business entities in Indonesia (Suliswanto & Rofik, 2019; Suryawardani et al., 2021). Regarding micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs) working on ecoprint textiles, Tembindigo endorsed the “.co.id” domain, which is intended for businesses and private organizations, thereby enhancing its digital credibility (Prabowo et al., 2023). The domain was registered through a provider offering e-commerce services, which required the submission of documents such as the Business Identification Number (BIN), the owner’s ID card, and a business email, as per the legal framework (Diapepin et al., 2024). After activating the domain, the project team performed DNS (Domain Name System) configuration, linked the domain to a hosting server, and developed a modern, responsive website using WordPress. Designed professionally, the website included an integrated digital marketing product catalog and company profile, an online ordering interface, social media links, and other multifunctional tools. Opting for the “.co.id” domain not only met regulatory requirements but also bolstered brand perception, reinforced digital brand equity, and cultivated trust from consumers domestically and globally.

The availability of well-managed administrative records and documentation from previous activities closely supported the successful design of the professional website. Tembindigo MSME has demonstrated strong internal management practices, particularly in organizing information related to product types, operational activities, and long-term business targets. This structured documentation greatly facilitated the development of a professional website, as it provided clear reference materials for content creation and layout design. The following section presents the validation activities conducted during the website development process at Tembindigo MSME.

As a part of an overarching strategic step in an MSME’s digital transformation process, validation of Tembindigo’s professional website is captured in Figure 2. It was established during the functional access test that the website can be accessed both in desktop and mobile formats. All important components that comprise the product catalog, including information on production processes, the company profile, customer testimonials, an order form, as well as WhatsApp contact integration, are functioning properly (Mardiani et al., 2023; Tarso, 2024). Additionally, the site features a bilingual interface in both Bahasa Indonesia and English, which is essential for reaching a global audience. Validation was conducted with the MSME partner through navigational tests, form completion, and scrutiny of the content’s structure, quality, and general standards.

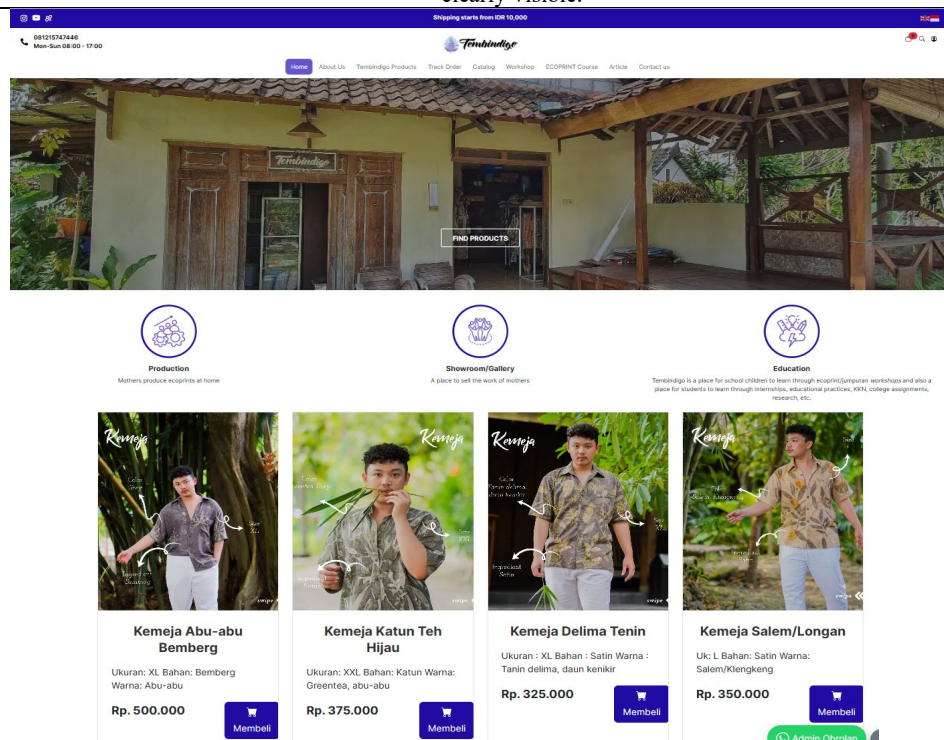


Figure 2. Functional Validation and Professional Website Feature Checklist

The findings showed a favorable response, especially regarding ease of access and the professionalism of the user interface (Putri Diary et al., 2023). The partner noted that the website has improved their corporate image, broadened market access, and enhanced promotional activities in both educational and transactional contexts (Suharyati et al., 2023). They also highlighted the management of visuals and narrative as distinguishing factors relative to competition among MSMEs, especially those rooted in local value (Lestari, 2022). These findings suggest that the development of a professional website should incorporate integrated communication systems, advanced product imagery, multilingual options, and brand identity reinforcement as key elements (Gao et al., 2023). The success of this case serves as a model for other MSMEs seeking digital transformation and market expansion while emphasizing innovative and genuine digital marketing techniques. The outcomes of the functional access test and the feature checklist for the website, validated with the owner and employees, are in Table 4.

Table 4. Functional Access Test Results and Tembindigo Website Feature Checklist

Tested aspects	Status	Description of findings
Active and publicly accessible website	✓ Active	The tembindigo.co.id website can be accessed well via desktop and mobile. The display is clean and responsive.
Complete and structured product catalog display	✓ Available	There is a "Product" page that displays various product categories such as fashion and craft, complete with images, names, and prices.
Production process information page available	✓ Available	The "Workshop" and "About Us" sections explain the ecoprint production process, motif philosophy, and natural approach used in a narrative manner.
Business profile page and customer testimonials displayed	✓ Available	The "About Us" page explains the history and mission of the business. Several customer testimonial quotes are also displayed in visual content.
Order form feature active	✓ Active	The "Contact" page provides an order and consultation form that is directly connected to the manager's email.
WhatsApp admin contact feature available	✓ Available	There is a WhatsApp icon in the lower right corner of the site that is directly connected to the UMKM admin.
Website available in two languages	✓ Available	There are English and Indonesian menus in the upper right corner, although the main display is Indonesian.
Links to social media available	✓ Available	Active links to Instagram and YouTube accounts are available at the top and bottom of the site. The link to Shopee is not yet clearly visible.



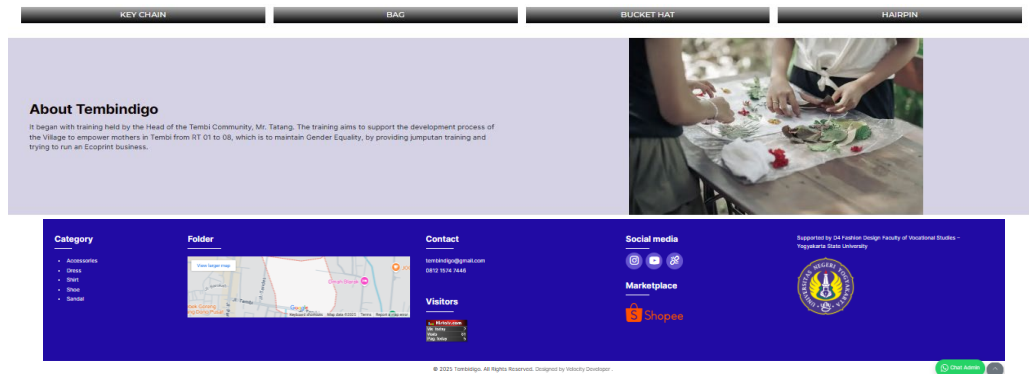


Figure 3. Professional Website Appearance, including the Topmost section, the body, and the footer section

Source: <https://tembindigo.co.id/>

The design interface of tembindigo.co.id features a clean and minimalist structure that meets functional requirements. This provides solid branding for the company, as it utilizes natural and pleasing-to-the-eye colors and visuals. The topmost section, or header region, contains the Tembindigo logo and a primary navigation menu with links to Home, About Us, Products, Workshop, and Contact, allowing users to navigate the site easily. The body of the site focuses on integrating the ecoprint story and product catalog, featuring high-definition photographs, informative details about the production process, and testimonials from customers. In the footer section, users can find contact details, social media accounts (Instagram and Shopee), and a map to the gallery's location. Moreover, the website allows users to directly message the admin via WhatsApp for order placement and consultations, which is facilitated by a button located in the sidebar. Figure 3 illustrates the professional structure of the Tembindigo website.

The evaluation of Tembindigo MSME's social media management, integrated with the professional website, was conducted using six key aspects as indicators of performance and achievement. The results of the integrated social media and website management evaluation are presented in Figure 4.

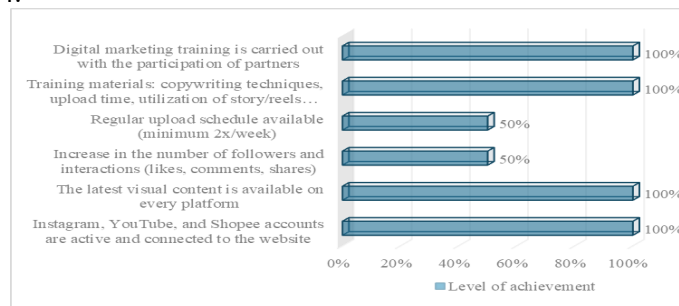


Figure 4. Evaluation of Integrated Social Media Management on the Tembindigo Website

The analysis conducted on Tembindigo's social media management for MSMEs reveals that the integration of Instagram and YouTube with the Shopee account has been properly implemented, and their links to the main website contribute to a well-structured digital business ecosystem (Risdiyanto et al., 2023). The partnered MSMEs' understanding of visual branding and its importance in promoting ecoprint products is evident as they provide regularly updated visuals with high aesthetic appeal (Sunarso et al., 2023). Limited active audience participation and follower growth indicate that a more aggressive engagement plan is needed. The lack of regular posting has also hindered the continuity of communication with digital consumers, which is crucial for fostering long-lasting relationships through social media.

Training sessions focused on copywriting and the application of interactive features, such as stories and reels, were conducted zealously, and the partner showcased a remarkable willingness to acquire new skills (Suryawardani et al., 2021). Such results support the argument that effective management of content and interaction with users is crucial in nurturing customer engagement as part of the overarching strategy to strengthen longitudinal digital customer loyalty (Fridayani et al., 2024). In light of this, it is recommended that MSMEs establish a standardized system for drafting editorial content calendars, conducting regular analysis of social media metrics, and honing a

stronger and consistent brand image, as well as maintaining brand coherence. Therefore, for MSMEs such as Tembindigo to adapt and thrive amid the shifting dynamics of international digital marketing, an all-encompassing and enduring strategy for digital brand development is necessary.

Following the evaluation of social media integration with the website, the next phase involved assessing the Digital Appeal through Storytelling and Product Visualization, measured across five key aspects. The visualization of the website's digital appeal is presented in Figure 5.

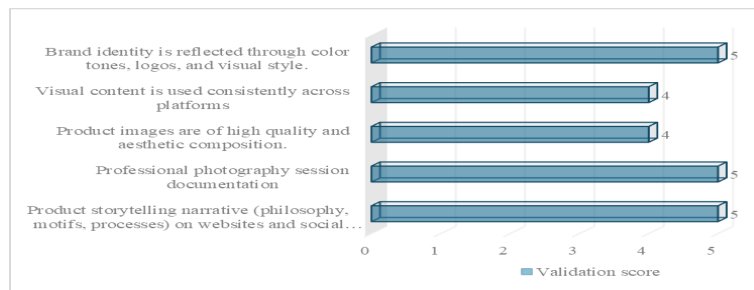


Figure 5. Website Attractiveness Evaluation

The effort to enhance the digital image of Tembindigo MSME's ecoprint products through storytelling and product visualization has significantly strengthened its professional image, along with the emotional branding value associated with the products. Validation results showed that the storytelling narratives, particularly the "Motifs, Natural Dyes, and The Production Journey", were fully executed on the website and social media platforms, receiving the highest score in content evaluation. The professional photography sessions conducted vividly documented the fabrics with distinct artworks and compositions that elevated the products' aesthetic value and exclusivity (McCormick & Livett, 2012). While these assets have been incorporated throughout the brand's digital ecosystem, opportunities still exist for improving upload consistency, visual uniformity, and tone (Xiao et al., 2023). The Keway Merah brand identity is reinforced by the use of natural color palettes, where green hues are predominantly featured, a logo that incorporates a leaf, and an educational yet elegant design style that embodies the local philosophy and sustainability (Kusumasondjaja, 2019). This intentional brand imagery aligns with strengthening consumer perception and emotional resonance, while connecting to brand loyalty, which previous studies have identified as crucial, stemming from aesthetic imagery (Correa et al., 2024; Reimann et al., 2010). Thus, the combination of story-driven narrative frameworks with precise visual branding as a primary approach enables MSMEs, such as Tembindigo, to enhance their presence in the digital space, increase consumer interaction, and cultivate sustained brand loyalty.

The following displays the validation results concerning storytelling and product visualization for Tembindigo MSME. The graph shows that: (1) Both the product narratives and the photos taken of the products were done to perfection since both were given a score of 5; (2) The visual quality of the products as well as their uniform application to different/publication platforms were assessed as very good, both earning 4 with a room for improvement; and (3) Brand identity comprising the use color scheme, logo, and overall very visual style was regarded as strong and consistent earning also a 5. The MSME partner said this has increased their pride in the products and simplified for consumers the appreciation of the uniqueness of each product. The results suggest that the fusion of storytelling and spatial strategies not only enhances brand communication but also fosters a deeper emotional resonance with both local and international audiences. For MSMEs seeking to undergo a digital transformation rooted in culture, this approach provides a best-practice model to be emulated.

According to sales records, Tembindigo's ecoprint product sales experienced a marked increase in June 2025, coinciding with the site's use as a digital marketing tool. Sales of ecoprint accessories increased from 12 to 27 units, which is a 125% increase, due to the attractive displays and ease of ordering via WhatsApp. Garments and outerwear experienced a 40% increase in sales, which is attributed to the website's compelling narratives that showcase the designs. The number of workshop sessions conducted increased from 2 to 5 due to greater visibility on the website and social media regarding the educational services offered. Furthermore, the online order form

integrated into the website facilitated nine new transactions, demonstrating its potential for digitally driven customer conversions.

Table 5. Comparative data on ecoprint product sales based on the website for the period June 2025

Product/Service Type	Sales without Website	Website-based Sales	Description
Ecoprint Accessories (bags, scarves, wallets)	12 pcs	27 Pcs	Up 125% – Influenced by product visuals & WhatsApp orders
Ecoprint Sheet Fabric	8 Sheets	10 Sheets	Up 25% – Demand is still limited, needs further promotion
Fashion Products (clothes, outerwear)	5 Pieces	7 pieces	Up 40% – Attractiveness increases thanks to storytelling motifs
Ecoprint Workshop/Training	2 sessions (small group)	5 sessions	Up 150% – Driven by detailed information on website & IG
Ordering via Online/Website Form	-	9 transactions	New channels – Effective as customer conversion points

Website visitor statistics for Tembindigo during the period of June 1 to July 6 indicate a significant upward trend beginning in mid-June (Figure 6). At the start of the month, traffic remained very low, with minimal user activity. A dramatic spike began on June 16, marked by a simultaneous increase in the number of new visitors, total visits, and page views. Peak traffic occurred on June 18, 22, and 30, with page views exceeding 120 per day and unique visitors reaching over 60 individuals. This indicates that users were not merely visiting briefly, but were actively exploring multiple sections of the site, such as the product catalog, company profile, and workshop information. The recurring weekly spikes suggest a correlation with scheduled content updates and promotions shared via social media platforms. While there was a slight decrease in traffic in early July, overall visitor engagement remained high—indicating that the website had begun to gain strong recognition among users. These findings reinforce the conclusion that website development and digital branding have had a tangible impact on increasing exposure and consumer interest in Tembindigo's MSME products.

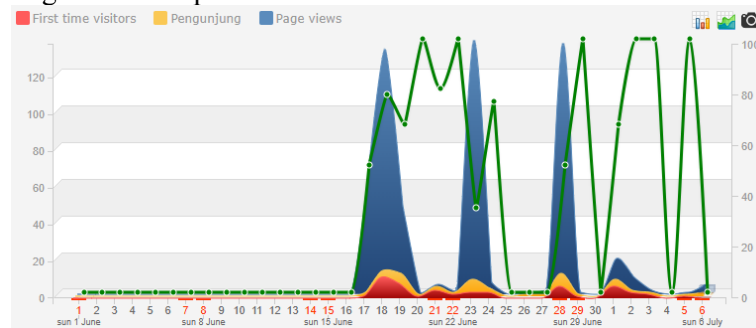


Figure 6. Evaluation of Visitor Data During June 2025 (new visitors)

The results of the website-based digital marketing and branding project conducted at Tembindigo MSME have shown a noticeable improvement in visibility and professionalism, as well as an aesthetic enhancement for the ecoprint products (Risdiyanto et al., 2023; Sunarso et al., 2023). The website's integration with social media platforms demonstrated a more seamless digital marketing ecosystem, as evidenced by increased website visits, heightened sales of accessory products, and increased interest in workshops. Brand identity has been reinforced and an emotional connection with consumers strengthened through the product visualization strategy, which includes professional photography and storytelling about motifs, natural dyeing, and the creative process (Melati et al., 2023; Sugiana et al., 2023). Although the outcomes are encouraging, there is still a need for improvement, such as maintaining a consistent content upload schedule and developing fully bilingual websites, which would enable greater global audience engagement (Panjaitan & Indriani, 2022; SARI et al., 2021). These results confirm that website-based digital branding is replicated by other MSMEs, especially those in the creative sector, which is anchored in local traditions, to widen their market both domestically and internationally. In addition, embedding branded storytelling and visuals to strengthen digital presence has been shown to deepen consumer participation and fortify brand resilience amid a fierce competitive environment

CONCLUSION

The community service project carried out at Tembindigo MSME addressed issues related to the lack of a cohesive digital marketing strategy and a unified, integrated digital marketing platform. The establishment of a professionally designed website, which includes a product catalog, business profile, production processes, and an order form, has improved the enterprise's visibility and professional image. The website's embedded social media, coupled with instruction on digital content management, has helped to retain customers and facilitated the online purchase of accessory items as well as ecoprint workshops. The professional photography, paired with philosophy-driven storytelling, is used to describe the products, enhancing brand recognition and reinforcing visually appealing aspects while enabling consumers to appreciate the products' value. The results of validation have proven that a methodical, ongoing, and cooperative effort to digitally brand MSMEs via websites is a suitable approach for enterprises to embrace the digital world, while providing a best practice model for other ecoprint-based enterprises. The approach is not only replicable but also serves as a guide for other ecoprint-based enterprises.

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